Chroma

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Collections

# Adding Data to Chroma Collections

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Learn how to add data to Chroma collections.

## Adding Data

Use `.add` to insert new records into a collection. Each record needs a unique string `id`.

Python TypeScript Rust

```
collection.add(
    ids=["id1", "id2", "id3"],
    documents=["lorem ipsum...", "doc2", "doc3"],
    metadatas=[{"chapter": 3, "verse": 16}, {"chapter": 3, "verse": 5}, {"chapte
)
```

You must provide either `documents`, `embeddings`, or both. `metadatas` are always optional. When only providing `documents`, Chroma will generate embeddings for you using the collection's **embedding function**.

If you've already computed embeddings, pass them alongside `documents`. Chroma will store both as-is without re-embedding the documents.

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```
    embeddings=[[1.1, 2.3, 3.2], [4.5, 6.9, 4.4], [1.1, 2.3, 3.2]],
    documents=["doc1", "doc2", "doc3"],
    metadatas=[{"chapter": 3, "verse": 16}, {"chapter": 3, "verse": 5}, {"chapte
)
```

If your documents are stored elsewhere, you can add just embeddings and metadata. Use the `ids` to associate records with your external documents. This is a useful pattern if your documents are very large, such as high-resolution images or videos.

Python TypeScript Rust

```
collection.add(
    ids=["id1", "id2", "id3"],
    embeddings=[[1.1, 2.3, 3.2], [4.5, 6.9, 4.4], [1.1, 2.3, 3.2]],
    metadatas=[{"chapter": 3, "verse": 16}, {"chapter": 3, "verse": 5}, {"chapte
)
```

## Metadata

Metadata values can be strings, integers, floats, or booleans. Additionally, you can store arrays of these types.

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```
    documents=[ lorem ipsum... ],
    metadatas=[{
        "chapter": 3,
        "tags": ["fiction", "adventure"],
        "scores": [1, 2, 3],
    }],
)
```

All elements in an array must be the same type, and empty arrays are not allowed. You can filter on array metadata using the `$contains` and `$not_contains` operators — see **Metadata Filtering** for details.

## Behaviors

- If you add a record with an ID that already exists in the collection, it will be ignored without throwing an error. In order to overwrite data in your collection, you must **update** the data.
- If the supplied embeddings don't match the dimensionality of embeddings already in the collection, an exception will be raised.

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